

Accessibility & Inclusivity Checklist

Reusable QA Tool — Applied to Discovering Your Narrative Voice

This is written to be reusable on other modules, not just this one — the criteria are general enough to apply anywhere on the platform, and the right two columns show how they were applied here as a worked example. "Pass" means the current module already meets the criterion. "Fixed" means it didn't originally and now does, with the change built and live. "Proposed" means a fix is specified but not yet implemented. "Gap" means identified and not yet resolved.

1. Platform & Access

Criterion	Status	Notes / Where Verified
No content requires an active internet connection to complete.	Fixed	Screen 5 (Craft Tips) and Screen 8 (embedded excerpt) replace external links. See Content Review Case Study, Cases 2 and 4.
No task depends on a tool or system outside the platform that hasn't been verified to exist.	Pass	Activities write to paper/notebook, not a digital tool — confirmed, see Content Outline Blueprint, Section 5.
Module functions the same regardless of facility hardware variance (screen size, touch sensitivity).	Gap	Not verified against actual device models in circulation — see Needs & Audience Analysis, Section 7 (Open Questions).

2. Learner Control & Pacing

Criterion	Status	Notes / Where Verified
No content is gated behind a forced wait with no visible way to proceed or skip.	Fixed	Screen 2 built and confirmed live. Screens 7 and 10 proposed with the identical fix.
Learner can repeat, revisit, or slow down without penalty or visible tracking of attempts.	Pass	Accordion and journal-based activities are inherently self-paced; no attempt-count or scoring exists anywhere in the module.
No comparative or competitive element (leaderboard, ranking, public score).	Pass	Confirmed absent — see Instructional Strategy, Section 3.

3. Language & Content

Criterion	Status	Notes / Where Verified
No stigmatizing, clinical, or institutional language in instructional copy.	Fixed	"Broken home" prompt replaced — see Content Review Case Study, Case 5.
Instructions phrased as invitations, not commands.	Fixed	Video prompt reworded from all-caps command to lowercase invitation.

Criterion	Status	Notes / Where Verified
Copy checked against a plain-language reading level target (approx. 8th-9th grade).	Proposed	Target stated in Style Guide, Section 3; not yet verified line-by-line against a readability tool.
No content assumes shared trauma, hardship, or personal disclosure from the learner.	Pass	Revised character prompts ask about motivation, not biography — no prompt requires the learner to reference their own life.

4. Visual & Interaction Accessibility

These criteria sit in this checklist rather than a separate design review because visual and interaction choices affect learning outcomes directly — see the Style Guide & Design Rationale, "Why This Document Exists," for the full argument. Contrast, tap targets, and icon clarity aren't polish; for this audience they're the difference between a learner completing a task and getting stuck without knowing why.

Criterion	Status	Notes / Where Verified
No icon-only navigation — every icon is paired with a text label.	Pass	Confirmed across all 14 screens; header book icon is paired with course title text, not used alone as a nav control.
Sufficient color contrast between text/buttons and background.	Proposed	Green-on-tan CTA buttons appear high-contrast on visual inspection; not yet verified against a formal WCAG contrast checker.
Generous, forgiving tap targets for an audience that may be new to touchscreens.	Proposed	Not yet measured against a minimum target size standard; flagged for follow-up in a full accessibility pass.
Audio and text content are reviewed for parity, and any difference is intentional and documented.	Pass	Screen 3 includes audio narration, Screen 4 doesn't — confirmed intentional (chunking, not an oversight), see Storyboard/Wireframe notes.

5. What This Checklist Doesn't Cover

This audit was built from static screenshots, not a live accessibility scan. Screen reader compatibility, formal WCAG contrast ratios, and physical tap-target measurements are flagged as "Proposed" or "Gap" rather than marked Pass, because they weren't and couldn't be verified from the material available. A genuine pre-publish accessibility pass would need direct testing against the live module, not just this document.